the top global economic governance steering group in 2008, during the global financial crisis.[8] The BRICS governments also coordinated on their own to develop and exercise outside options, notably the creation of their own New Development Bank (NDB), and Contingent Reserve Arrangement (CRA). Even as it compromised with its BRICS partners on the organizing principles of the NDB, China also opted to exercise its own outside option to create a bank in which it would be the indisputable leader, the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB). Seeking support from both the major Western powers *and* its BRICS partners, China invited two of its fellow BRICS partners, India and Russia, to be the leading shareholders in the AIIB, after itself, followed by major European powers and other countries, including Brazil.

This chapter examines four cases in which the four (through 2010) and later five BRICS governments attempted to coordinate the international financial statecraft of their respective national governments, 2008 to mid-2016. The cases were selected on the basis of two criteria. First, as a set, they represent each of the four types of collective financial statecraft summarized in Table 3.2. Second, the financial statecraft actions taken in these cases are substantive and nontrivial "hard tests" of the proposition that BRICS are a club pursuing its members' shared interests, as opposed to a merely rhetorical or symbolic group incapable of sustained significant collective action.[9] Successful collaboration in any of these collective financial statecraft actions over the medium run demonstrates a significant bid by the BRICS to influence the rules, norms, and distribution of influence in global financial governance or markets.

The cases do not constitute a representative sample of the universe of all possible international financial interactions among these states in this time period, in which circumstance the chapter also might have included notable failures to collaborate. The last section of this chapter briefly considers some of the most important instances of noncollaboration in collective financial statecraft to probe the scope of the larger universe of cases that may be useful to investigate in future research. A second research design challenge is the ongoing nature of the cases, which implies that the current level of "successful" BRICS cooperation in these cases could change. Some cases, such as the creation of the NDB, represent relatively recent initiatives, while others, such as IMF reforms, represent more long-standing common concerns.